India 2050 — LASI Research & Data Access Brief

Portfolio evidence package • independent research/data-access preparation

1. Research purpose

This brief turns the India 2050 portfolio question into a reproducible research request. The proposed analysis examines care need, informal support and paid/professional caregiving among adults aged 60+ using LASI Wave 1. No paid-care demand or conversion rate is claimed until microdata are obtained, cleaned, weighted and analyzed.

2. Research topic (draft)

Care need, informal support and paid/professional caregiving among older adults in India: a descriptive analysis of LASI Wave 1.

India is experiencing a major demographic transition while family structures, migration, urbanisation and labour-force participation may change how care is provided. This study proposes a descriptive analysis of LASI Wave 1 to understand functional care need, receipt and intensity of assistance, helper type/relationship, and whether assistance is paid. The analysis will focus on adults aged 60+ and examine variation by age, sex, living arrangement and geography where the sample supports reliable estimates. The objective is not to estimate a commercial market size or establish causal relationships. Instead, it is to build an evidence base for understanding how much care need exists, how that need is currently supported, and where the observed mix of family and paid/professional support may warrant further research. Results will use appropriate survey design/weights, transparent denominators, documented missing-data handling and explicit limitations. This forms part of an independent healthcare strategy portfolio project examining future care capacity in India.

3. Research objectives

• Estimate ADL and IADL limitation prevalence among adults aged 60+.

• Estimate receipt of help and characterize care intensity where measurable.

• Describe helper relationship/type, including paid and professional assistance.

• Examine descriptive differences by living arrangement, age, sex and state/UT where sample support permits.

• Explore the observed relationship between functional need and paid/professional care use without interpreting association as causation or market demand.

4. Requested data modules

Module	Purpose
IND & BM	Individual health, functional limitations and caregiving characteristics.
HH	Household characteristics and economic context.
HH_Roster	Household composition and relationships.
Community	Infrastructure, facilities and access context where relevant.

5. Questionnaire concepts to verify

Planning map: HT401–HT413 (ADL/IADL difficulty); HT424 (help); HT425 (number of helpers); HT426 (main helper); HT427 (helper relationship/type); HT428 (days); HT429 (hours/day); HT430 (paid status). Exact released microdata variable names, codes, weights, strata, clusters and missing-value conventions must be verified from the current codebook.

6. Analysis workflow

• Obtain approved microdata and codebook; record version and access conditions.

• Inspect coding, missingness and survey-design fields before deriving measures.

• Define the 60+ analysis cohort and apply the appropriate survey weights/design.

• Derive functional-need, assistance, paid-care and intensity measures with explicit denominators.

• Run weighted descriptive estimates and qualified state/UT comparisons where sample support permits.

• Create one reproducible analytical table, one decision-oriented visual and a short methods note.

• Update the portfolio only with results traceable to the released data and documented methodology.

7. Guardrails

Training volume ≠ deployed workforce. Household structure ≠ actual caregiver availability. Paid-care use ≠ willingness to pay or market demand. Historical LASI results ≠ a 2026 current-state estimate. Associations will not be presented as causal effects.

8. Access/request note

The current IIPS LASI process requests identity proof and a stated research purpose, topic and proposal/data requirement. If applying independently, use the truthful purpose category available on the form; do not invent an institutional affiliation. Stata is preferred for a reproducible survey-analysis workflow, with SPSS as an alternative.

Portfolio value

This document does not claim a research result. It demonstrates disciplined research design: a precise question, explicit variables, reproducible analysis, denominator discipline and a clear boundary between evidence and hypotheses.

Reference note

Primary documentation: International Institute for Population Sciences (IIPS), LASI Wave 1 data catalogue, data request form and individual questionnaire. Final submission should use the latest official IIPS documentation available at the time of application.